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Mitchell Linegar

CURRENT POSITION

Washington University in St. Louis 2026–present
Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Political Science
and DI2 Accelerator (Digital Intelligence & Innovation)

DOCTORAL STUDIES

California Institute of Technology (Caltech)
Ph.D., Social Science, 2026
Dissertation: "On (Mis)Information"

PRIOR EDUCATION

Reed College 2018
B.A., Mathematics–Economics

FIELDS

Political Methodology; American Politics; Political Communication

PUBLICATIONS

"American Voters' Views on Election Fraud, 2008–2024," with S. Chang and R. M. Alvarez. Forthcoming, *Political Research Quarterly*.

"Towards Scalable AI-Assisted Pre-Bunking of Election Misinformation: Evidence from a Pre-Registered US Panel Experiment," with B. Sinclair, S. van der Linden, and R. M. Alvarez. *Royal Society Open Science*, 13(8):252226, 2026.

"Online Moderation in Competitive Action Games: How Intervention Affects Player Behaviors," with R. Kocielnik, Z. Li, et al. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CHI PLAY)*, 9(6):96–130, 2025.

"American Views About Election Fraud in 2024," with R. M. Alvarez. *Frontiers in Political Science*, 6:1493897, 2024.

"Challenges in Moderating Disruptive Player Behavior in Online Competitive Action Games," with R. Kocielnik, Z. Li, et al. *Frontiers in Computer Science*, 6:1283735, 2024.

"Large Language Models and Political Science," with R. Kocielnik and R. M. Alvarez. *Frontiers in Political Science*, 5:1257092, 2023.

WORKING PAPERS

What Makes a Good Summary? Learning Sufficient Representations at Scale.

AI-Authored Prebunking Against Election Rumors: Evidence from Articles and Chatbots. With B. Sinclair, S. van der Linden, and R. M. Alvarez. Revise and resubmit, *Political Science Research and Methods*.

American Susceptibility to Misinformation. With S. Chang, S. van der Linden, B. Sinclair, and R. M. Alvarez. Under review, *Political Behavior*.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Prebunking Conversations and Institutional Confidence: Evidence from Election and Vaccine Misinformation. With B. Sinclair, S. van der Linden, and R. M. Alvarez.

MOE Voter Communications Study. Field evaluation of an AI election-information assistant developed with the Missouri Secretary of State's office. With B. Sinclair and R. M. Alvarez.

A Structural Model of Partisan News Consumption and Political Outcomes. With G. Martin and A. Yurukoglu.

POLICY WRITING

"Generative AI and the Future of Elections," with R. M. Alvarez and F. Eberhardt. Policy Brief, Caltech Center for Science, Society, and Public Policy, 2023.

PUBLIC-FACING TOOLS

MOE. AI assistant that answers voters' questions about registration, deadlines, and voting procedures from official Missouri sources and state election law, citing each answer. Developed with the Missouri Secretary of State's office; its knowledge base covers all 116 Missouri local election authorities. 2026

ElectionBot (electionbot.chat). Tools that draft pre-bunking articles from trusted facts and run domain-specific chatbots; the interventions in the preregistered experiments above.

SOFTWARE

treepo (github.com/mlinegar/treepo). Python package for summarization with compression trees: learning and auditing summaries of long documents.

Programming: Python, R, Julia, Lean 4.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2026: New Directions in Analyzing Text as Data (TADA), UC Berkeley; American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, New York; Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth), Michigan State; Election Science, Reform, and Administration (ESRA), Arizona State; Caltech Seminar Day

2025: Trust & Safety Research Conference, Stanford; ESRA, Florida State; Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), Chicago; Texas Methods Meeting (talk and poster), Houston; Information and Misinformation in Elections, Caltech

2024: MPSA, Chicago

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Everhart Lecture Series Finalist, Caltech 2026
Caltech AI Alignment Fellow 2023–2025
Stanford GSB Research Fellow 2018–2020

TEACHING

All as Teaching Assistant at Caltech.

SS 224: Social Science Data (graduate methods), Prof. R. M. Alvarez. 2024, 2025, 2026
PS 123: The Politics of Regulation, Prof. D. R. Kiewiet. Winter 2026
CMS/CS/EE/IDS 144: Networks: Structure & Economics, Profs. A. Wierman and E. Mazumdar. Winter 2023

RELEVANT POSITIONS

Research Fellow, Stanford Graduate School of Business 2018–2020